Report
2023

/ OUR RESPONSIBILITY

Our approach to responsibility inspires our products, guidelines, organisation, and recruitment, as well as our skills and the way we operate what we do. Just as we apply *design to cost*, there should be *design to responsibility* to invent. To succeed, we need everyone..

/ Guides

We are an industrial group specialised in the design, manufacturing, and maintenance of complex lifting and handling equipment and integrated systems solutions across a wide range of industries: Aeronautics, Aluminium, Defense, Large Infrastructure, Hydro-energy, Industry and Environment, Nuclear, Offshore and Renewable.

Our values stem from a long industrial history that began in 1946:
> Health and safety (of all stakeholders)
> Performance
> Customer satisfaction (quality, safety, attentiveness, innovation, and responsiveness)
> Respect (of all stakeholders)
> Commitment (involvement, honesty, loyalty, and trust)
> Passion (for technique, a job well done, and human values)

In 2022, we earned sales revenues of 540 million Euros, and our workforce is 2,600 strong, with employees of 30 nationalities in 15 countries.

This report presents the actions taken by the end of 2022 and covers only the scope of REEL International.

Report
2023

/ OUR RESPONSIBILITY

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/ EDITORIAL

The Executive Committee

REEL and Responsibility...

Tackling CSR topics is not new to us.
First was safety, of course: over the last twenty years, the accident frequency rate has been cut by a factor of 8. This is attributable, first, to the development of a safety framework adapted to our business, followed by the Take Care Plan action plan that implements best practices, including golden rules, safety rituals, and the ambitious safety interaction programme. At last, a major training plan to spread the safety culture throughout the group, which is summarised in the following pages.

We are also positioned as an employer of choice operating according to an exemplary governance, and demonstrating strong values. We have implemented a code of ehtics and a code of conducts for our employees, and are committed towards the quality of life in the workplace, through our latest programme, *FEEL GOOD TOGETHER*, born in the aftermath of COVID and which takes concrete action, such as the creation of an employee shareholding plan and the perpetuation of remote work for positions where it is possible.

This document is aimed at presenting the various aspects of our responsibility process.
It is a first, and in some way, a pilot report that reviews and illustrates the significant stakes the group faces.
It will help you discover our responsible approach in a way that is factual, personified, in-depth, and demanding!

Factual
This document presents facts and achievements, stating clearly what we do every day, on every site, at the mployee level.

Personified
This document gives the men and women of the company a voice. Their accounts show how our teams fulfil our commitments.

In-depth
You may be surprised at the level of detail some articles provide. This level of granularity is intentional: it reflects our ambition to share and educate, as well as our culture as a business working in critical environments.

Demanding
The REEL world you are about to discover is far from perfect: continuous improvement is a daily part of our culture. It is why most of the topics conclude with the paths to progress that we have identified.

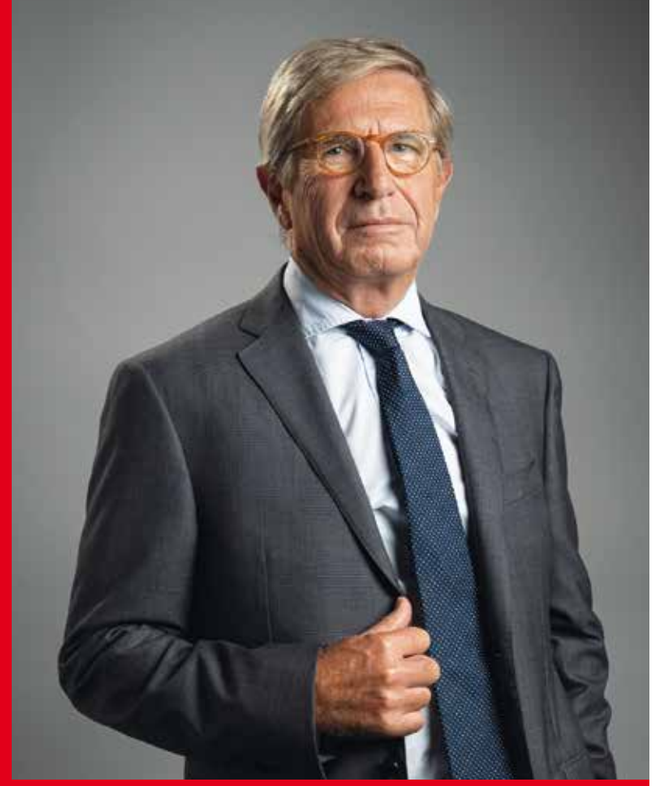
And there are many!

Happy reading.

The Executive Committee

/ INTERVIEW

Philippe FRANTZ
CEO of the REEL International Group



**How does responsibility manifest?
What is the common thread throughout the company?**

There are many, but I would say that the two main pillars – as they have been throughout our history – are our customers and our teams! Since our inception, and we have seen it at every stage of our development, we grow thanks to our customers' demands, requirements, performance expectations, and stakes. We work in highly competitive fields, and there is no reason to think that this pressure will weaken. Customers make several demands, the first of which is compliance. It is something they care deeply about, as do we. The second is nonfinancial performance, something they are increasingly sensitive to and give non-negligible weight to in their calls for proposals.
The third is the evolution of our markets, which translates into expectations for low-carbon strategies or the development of equipment for renewable energy.

**How do employees react?
How do they drive these developments?**

It is enthusiastic, and our teams push the envelope in every field so that we may forge ahead.
People have long been a core part of the group's values, be it through health and safety, respect, passion, and commitment. When we celebrated the company's 75th anniversary, we held events so the executive committee and all employees could connect directly. Environmental stake was one of employees' most pressing concerns. We must address every aspect of our environmental responsibility, if only to set the example.
We are aware that we are only just getting started in certain areas, such as the transportation of our equipment.

For a complete portrait of our stakeholders, we should also include our economic and financial environment. The topic has taken such a central place that it influences terms of access to funding. While it may not be a current issue for us, it reflects a wider context that we should take into account.

"We know how to do more with less"

In what ways is CSR an opportunity?

It is a definite opportunity to spotlight topics to which we have made longstanding commitments. I think of employee safety, an area where we have done extensive in-depth work, or the actions we have taken to be an exemplary employer. In reality, the changes are far greater – I would go so far as to say they are cultural and existential shifts!

What do you mean by that?

Our history was built on mastering the weight-to-performance ratio. Remember – the L in REEL stands for Light! When it comes to solutions where we can contribute our expertise, it's not an opportunity of circumstance, but rather, a deepening and a shift in our development strategy. It's about leveraging a strong technical culture: we know how to do more with less!
And we are still in the early days of this evolution.

In practical terms, how would you illustrate this budding evolution?

Every job, trade, and profession is involved in one way or another.
When it comes to wind power, we contribute to the search for solutions upstream and to their practical implementation downstream. In the nuclear industry, we take part in major research with ITER and in new nuclear initiatives such as EPR2 and SMR. As for aluminium, one of the industries that most needs to lower its carbon footprint, we have just appointed the group's first decarbonisation manager.

What are the predictable consequences of this evolution?

What stands true for aluminium now will spread to all areas: we need to prepare for rapid changes. That is what drives our roadmap, to highlight the emerging nature of the approach.
It is now up to us to make it a reality. Here again, we have to take a higher-level view. Personally, this responsibility approach should inspire our products, guidelines, organisation, and recruitment, as well as our skills and the ways we do what we do. Just as we train our teams on *design to cost,* there should be *design to responsibility*. To succeed, we need everyone.

/ PROTECTING HEALTH & SAFETY

We design, manufacture, install, and maintain equipment in safety-critical industrial environments. Given the variety of hazardous situations our employees may be exposed to, both in our facilities and on customer sites, employee health and safety is our top priority. As all entities have implemented actions plans specific to their business, the stake involves building and maintaining a group-wide safety culture based on a shared level of requirement. Our health and safety culture also acts as a token of our professionalism for stakeholders (customers and suppliers).

/ OUR ACTIONS

The Golden Rules

One of our 5 Golden Rules states *"I'm well-placed to carry out my task safely or else I'll stop"*. Employees are granted the right to withdraw if they feel their safety is at risk. It ensures that their safety takes precedence over financial or business concerns.

MY CARE: training managers to "See It – Say It" when it comes to safety

In 2020, we launched a project aimed at making profound changes to our health and safety culture. Our objective: 0 accident, ever, anywhere. This change in culture is realised through a new approach founded on "See It – Say It" safety observation and communication that encourages mutual concern. A network of 50 specially trained safety coaches was set up to spread this change in culture and support managers on the topic. Our safety coaches facilitated 1,300 sessions, training and coaching over 600 managers in the field. Several tools were also introduced: safety interactions, reporting of hazardous situations, safety share at the beginning of any meeting. Early results of this action plan are already visible, with more and more group entities showing a frequency rate of 0 (i.e. no lost-time injuries over a 12-month period).

Initiatives to support employee health

We have long been forerunners in caring for the health of group employees. We have been organising meetings with occupational physicians across France for over fifteen years. We discuss the best ways to anticipate risk and to design the most effective prevention policy we can. Early on, we held talks on topics such as occupational stress, addiction, and age-related fatigue, to name a few. We also called on field experts to share their experience on how to prevent musculoskeletal disorders, and we are now starting to test handling solutions in our plants. Discussions with personnel representatives have also led to the signing of generally innovative to test handling solutions in our plants and results-oriented corporate agreements in the area of health and safety.

Radiation protection management system

As a nuclear industry supplier that is authorized to work in controlled areas, we must control employee exposure to ionising radiation and prevent their contamination.
In 2022, we revised our radiation protection management system by officialising a dedicated policy owned by the group's deputy CEO in charge of nuclear activities and setting up a transverse management of radioprotection specialists.

MY CARE: spreading the safety culture to reach 0 accidents

A new employee perception survey on the topic of health and safety at REEL International will be conducted in early 2024 to see changes compared to the 2020 survey. Throughout 2023 and 2024, actions will raise awareness among employees, new recruits, and the employees of newly acquired companies, of the "See It – Say It" safety observation and communication process. Improved results also mean making sure that hazardous situations escalated through the REEL CARE app are addressed rapidly.

Casting safety interactions in a positive light

We now have to urge employees to make positive safety interactions that recognise and encourage exemplary behaviour, reframing safety as more than an obligation. They should be considered a lever to improve productivity, workplace wellness, and team togetherness.

Maintaining high customer satisfaction levels

Customer satisfaction surveys conducted in 2022 revealed that the group's safety culture was the most recurrent topic, for the first year ever.
That just goes to show that the highlighted topic is also a priority for our customers. REEL International must maintain its strict requirements to assure customers of controlled on-site interventions. The change in culture will also have to involve the suppliers brought in for ad hoc work on our projects.

KEY FIGURE
78%
PERCENTAGE OF REEL SITES WITH ZERO ACCIDENTS IN 2022

/
MY CARE, AN EFFECTIVE CHANNEL FOR CHANGE

With the support of the top management, the rollout of MY CARE throughout all group businesses and entities required the mobilisation of our employees, from safety coaches and local HSE people to managers trained on this new way of addressing workplace health and safety. Three managers share their feedback on the implementation of the project and how it translates in practical terms among their teams in their daily work.

Marie Methods, Logistics, and OPC Worksite Manager – Nuclear Production Division

"I supervise heat sink and nuclear island work in controlled areas. When it comes to heat sinks, the main risks involve handling loads, working at heights, and moving heavy loads – crushing and falling objects and persons. In controlled areas, employee radiation and contamination are the main risks, along with significant electrical hazards.
Team safety is not a new topic within the group, but it did take on a new dimension with the MY CARE project.
Having the support of an outside firm, naming and training safety coaches who, in turn, train managers, being challenged by management on follow-through – that requires substantial investment. As a safety coach, I pay close attention to how I broach the subject with my teams. Employees are receptive, and we can talk about safety calmly. Safety interactions are particularly effective when they target actually hazardous situations. The concept of risk is better understood and anticipated."

Gaven Foreman at the Larouche plant, REEL Aluminium – North American Division

"I am a production foreman at the Larouche site, in Canada. I lead a team of fifteen or so technicians: hydraulic press operators, welders, and the ARCAIR team that cuts metal.
My boss presented the MY CARE project to me, saying we could undergo training to better understand workplace health and safety and raise awareness among our teams on the shop floor. It was a welcome approach: until then, everything was almost always focused on production.
When I was trained, I became aware that everyone has to take charge of their own safety and of the safety of their coworkers. At the start of every shift, we hold a safety chat on a specific topic, from wearing PPE to handling lifting chains, and so on. We do at least 2 safety interactions a week, congratulating people when proper methods are applied, and taking corrective measures otherwise. Safety interactions have helped me grow closer to my teams. They are really about open, one-on-one communication. Since we have begun using these tools, our lost-time injuries have dropped by 90%! Everyone has bonded as a team, and it makes it a great place to work."

Cédrik Head of the Saint-Nazaire Agency – Aero Marine & Industry Division

"The Saint-Nazaire agency has a team of 40, most of whom are technicians who do work and maintenance on customer sites. They operate in environments that may pose various hazards: working at heights, welding hot work, concurrent site work management, hydraulic work with pressurised elements, electrical hazards, and exposure to hazardous products.
As I am responsible for the safety of my teams, I welcomed the initiative. Having group support and talking about safety in a single voice is reassuring. Safety chats are held every Tuesday at noon, and every employee can submit a topic to talk about risk perception. The digitalisation of safety interactions has facilitated their implementation with our technicians, who all have a smartphone. Benevolence comes first, no matter the authority dynamic. The goal is immediate correction. Escalating hazardous situations leads to action plans for the purposes of continuous improvement. They are also shared with customers when it falls within their scope of action. We carry out on-site inspections in the field to make sure that operators have the correct reflexes.
We have had no lost-time injuries since 2022. Now, we turn our focus to minor hazards – there are still plenty of those. The shift in safety culture has changed how I act as a manager."

/
AN AMBITIOUS RADIATION PROTECTION POLICY

As a tier-1 supplier for the nuclear industry, we have a radiation protection management system that meets a number of requirements, be they regulatory, contractual, or other. Almost 700 employees are directly affected by this universal process aimed at controlling their exposure to ionising radiation, keeping to the ALARA principle *(As Low As Reasonably Achievable).*

An organisation that stays close to the field under the supervision of top leadership

Work in radioactive environments require control over two specific hazards: external exposure to radiation and contamination from radioactive particles on or inside the body. Radioactivity is a natural phenomenon, and everyone is exposed to radiation. Certain types of rock naturally emit radiation. The average natural exposure in France is 3 millisieverts (mSv) per year. Millisivert is the unit of measurement for body exposure to radioactiviy.
We are also exposed to artificial radiation: abdominal X-rays typically represent 0.5 mSv, and scans can reach up to 10 mSv. Such very low doses do not pose a health risk. By definition, workers are exposed to material that emits radiation in the course of their work in radioactive environments. The goal of radiation protection, then, is to carry out work while limiting worker exposure to radiation as much as possible and avoiding contamination. Our radiation protection management system defines the measures we implement to this end. The radiation protection management system and our application of it are audited annually by independent body CEFRI*.
It is a regulatory requirement for REEL, which falls under the responsibility of designated lead Deputy CEO Olivier, and designated deputy lead Yann.
"Our actions target everyone classified as likely to be exposed to ionising radiation. We have a network of radiation protection advisors in our entities to assist managers in the operational management of radiation protection. They are in constant contact with our teams and customers to analyse the risks involved in all work carried out in controlled areas, check compatibility with our rules and objectives, and track personnel dosimetry," says Yann.
Every semester, the radiation protection advisors meet with the deputy lead to take stock of results, record changes that need to be made to procedure in light of the latest regulatory developments, and implement best practices in the field for our teams. As always when it comes to safety, radiation protection control involves the entire chain of command taking ownership of stakes and methods, as well as the personal commitment of every single worker.

High internal requirements

At the start of every year, we hold a management review of radiation protection.
"The review helps us set goals and obligations for the coming year and validate system developments to best adjust the current organisation," adds Yann.
When it comes to radiation exposure, the ALARA principle tolerates employee exposure to radiation, provided it is kept as low as possible.
"Current regulations set the threshold at 20 millisieverts (mSv) per year for category A workers.

We hold ourselves to an annual threshold of 10 mSv, or half as much. The goal is adjusted by each entity, based on its level of initial exposure: some have set thresholds of 4, 3, or even 1 mSv. We set stricter dose constraints for ourselves to limit employee exposure to ionising radiation.
Our work is organised (number of workers, work time, etc.) based on these constraints so as to limit individual employee exposure," he says.

Future improvements

Our efforts also involve controlling contamination hazards and dosimeter management. Every worker on site has 2 dosimeters: one provided by the employer and one by the operator. *"We will soon be setting new rules to recover dosimeters from employees in more timely fashion to have them sent to a laboratory for analysis. We also want to focus on controlling motion to avoid contamination dispersion. That means reminders of operating and material management procedures and constant vigilance. Our current control level is good, but in this field, we also aim for zero fault,"* concludes Yann.

** CEFRI: French committee for radiation protection certification (Comité Français de Certification en Radioprotection)*

/ BEING AN EMPLOYER OF CHOICE

The women and men of the group are the core drivers of a continuous improvement process that extends to every level of the organisation. Designing, manufacturing, and maintaining safe, reliable, high-performance machines in the most demanding environments is made possible through the coordination of highly diverse, and sometimes rare, technical skills and an entrepreneurial spirit that lives on despite the growth of the group.

/ OUR ACTIONS

Learn, learn, learn

We cultivate our talents, keeping them, developing them, and renewing them. Skills are closely monitored and assessments of gaps between required skills and acquired ones are used in training plans at every level.

At REEL's 75th anniversary celebrations, many attendees spoke of REEL as a "learning company". They spoke of mentors who trained new recruits, and even of families with three different generations of employees. The support and degree training of driven employees was mentioned, as were the graduate programmes that helped young graduates learn about different trades and find their way.

The external growth policy is also seen as an opportunity to share and enrich trade-specific know-how within the group. The men and women of the group are the driving force of this sharing, and the loyalty thus strengthened is a key factor for the group's future.

REEL Academy: passing expertise on

Beyond mentorship and buddy systems, employees seeking upskilling opportunities can access REEL Academy, our training school, throughout their career. The training it provides opens up many possibilities for professional growth.

To integrate the notion of learning company into our DNA and support our internationalisation, REEL Academy also offers
> English-language training modules
> A group of representatives in the various countries where the group is present
> E-learning on a dedicated platform
Employees can also become part-time trainers on expert subjects (subject-matter experts).

Fostering professional and geographic mobility

Professional and geographic mobility is a source of both performance improvement for the group and satisfaction for our employees.
Our presence in several countries and exchanges enabled by common projects help drive diversity and interculturality.
The graduate programme – an integration programme for young graduates focussing on discovery of a trade – means to facilitate mobility within the organisation. Young graduates are brought into a division and explore various trades for 2 years, learning about the various components of a project.
At the end of this period, they are assigned to the type of position that most appeals to them.

MY HEROES, a programme fostering quality of life in the workplace

The employee sports and wellness programme known as MY HEROES was launched in 2022 as part of the *FEEL GOOD TOGETHER* plan focussing on quality of life in the workplace. Employees collect points by completing individual or group sports challenges. Their annual score is converted into corporate donations to charitable organisations.

Telework without constraint

At REEL, projects call for teamwork, interaction, and responsiveness. Service is provided on customer sites and manufacturing in our plants. However, for the small share of positions where it is possible, we have given employees the opportunity to perform a portion of their work remotely, as they choose.

The Innovation Challenge

To foster our capacity for innovation, we launched the second edition of our Innovation Challenge, which calls on employees to submit innovative projects to upper management. Since the pioneering spirit applies to all topics, the 2024 Innovation Challenge will add ecodesign to project selection criteria.

Encouraging diversity

We are convinced that a gender-inclusive, multicultural team is always more productive and efficient than a unisex, monocultural group.
In 2022, we launched the AWARE programme – *Accelerate Women At REEL* – to attract, support, empower, and promote a growing number of women in technical, scientific, and management fields.

Communication

We have multiplied employee communication initiatives over the last few years. A project to set up interactive screens on all our sites and make them viewable on employee phones is currently undergoing tests to better address this major stake.

KEY FIGURE
84
RATIO OF MEN TO WOMEN AT REEL SAS

/ REEL ACADEMY: THE PROFESSIONALISATION OF INTERNAL TRAINING

Training employees on skills that aren't taught in schools and making sure expertise is passed on: for over fifteen years, REEL Academy has worked to address these issues that are critical to the group's continued success. In 2022, 1,200 people were trained.

Training on specific hard and soft skills

We produce special equipment that requires, in its design, manufacturing, or maintenance, very specific skills that cannot be acquired through traditional learning curricula. To preserve this expertise, the group decided in 2008 to create an in-house school, providing its first training on lifting – training that is still widely delivered. Other types of internships were then organised, focussing on maintenance trades. Most REEL Academy trainers are group employees, either active or recent retirees, and all modules are designed and prepared in-house, based on needs in the field.

Growing professionalisation

REEL Academy has been greatly professionalised over the last three years. It obtained CACES[1] authorisation for bridge cranes, so it can now deliver professional capability certification. It also received two certifications: QUALIOPI, which attests to the quality of its processes, and Certimétal, which is a must for delivering CQPM[2] certification for metalworking.
It has also recently developed e-learning. Today, REEL Academy offers over 300 training modules online through its e-learning platform! Along with general and academic training, there are modules dedicated to engineering – such as question plans – and video tutorials that come in handy when it comes to certain delicate maintenance operations.
The third development, per Christophe, Director of REEL Academy: *"Customer training has seen strong growth in 2023."*

Short-term prospects

In 2024, REEL Academy will be certified as a CFA[3] and will welcome students in the advanced technician certificate programme in industrial maintenance for the nuclear industry (currently "hosted" by the institute of industrial resources, IRI) along with other training programmes to meet demand in trades with employee shortages.

1 – Safe driving certification
2 – Certificate of joint qualification in metallurgy
3 – Apprentice training centre

Pressing plant needs

In the field, the need for trained personnel is growing, partly due to the resurgence of the nuclear industry.
"Ten years ago, we were working on knowledge transfer in preparation for future retirements. Now, we're anticipating rate increases in the nuclear sector," explains Stéphane, Director of Industrial Performance. *"We work in highly technical trades, with specific requirements, which makes it impossible to recruit someone and have them be immediately functional. Along with regulatory and REEL Academy training, a shadowing period with an experienced employee is a must for new hires. In other areas, you have to be flexible, since there are wide swings in workload.*
We also have to leverage the versatility between our sites, and between different trades."

/ LAUNCH OF AD HOC TRAINING FOR MAINTENANCE AND NUCLEAR WORK

In late 2022, having realised that recruiting maintenance technicians was increasingly difficult, and that current training did not meet our requirements, despite the fact service is a strategic business for us, we decided to partner with IRI (Institut des Ressources Industrielles) and set up an advanced technician certificate programme in industrial maintenance for the nuclear or aeronautics industry (bac+2), with the right content for our needs.
The 11 students of the first graduating class, which started in September 2023, received offers for work-study employment within the group. During their work internships, they will receive complementary training from REEL Academy.

The creation of the professionalisation training in special machine automation for the nuclear industry should help address the growing nuclear workload, an industry that, it goes without saying, requires qualified, experienced personnel. In September 2022, facing increasing difficulty in recruiting automation specialists, upper management approved the creation of dedicated bac+3 level training for students with an advanced technician certificate or people in a career transition. *"In talking with industry members, we saw a need for at least 20 automation specialists a year to fill the jobs available in the area,"* says Yvan, Director of BU Installed Base Projects and leader of the initiative. In less than nine months, he developed the training modules for the degree training, which will alternate between engineering in the Nuclear Division, IRI for non-nuclear-specific automation training, and REEL Academy for nuclear specialisation.

All 11 students of the first graduating class were offered open contracts once their training was certified, to meet needs in various engineering departments. *"To make sure the initiative lives on, we are already in talks with IRI about opening upcoming graduating classes to other companies. It would help generate new trained and skilled resources for the nuclear industry in a lasting way,"* concludes Yvan.

/ VALUES THAT BRING US TOGETHER

Eric Director of BU NFM and Embedded Systems, Defense & Cycle Division

"I joined REEL in 2018 when it took over NFM Systems business. Throughout the onboarding process under my responsibility, I realized that REEL was a very respectful company. It tackles problems head on and presents solutions to employees only once reliability has been proven. I chose to join the group for its culture of excellence, its diligent management, and its family DNA. Our leader is driving a long-term, ten-year strategy. Growth and intrapreneurial spirit coexist by keeping operational units on a human scale. Employees contribute to group development with a level of autonomy that is rarely seen elsewhere. During the June 2020 strategic committee meeting to establish the business plan, I submitted the idea of acquiring a company that built tooling for submarine hull assembly. Eighteen months later, it was a done deal, and the first business synergies had blossomed. The value of REEL International resides in the combined skill set of its employees, who are driven by a shared passion for what they make. The scale and scope of the projects they bring to life are another source of pride."

Michaël Director Installed Base Services, Nuclear Production Division

"The role of managers and their environment have changed tremendously in just a few years. Social issues are no longer the same, and new questions have emerged, for example harassment and discrimination issues, telework management, the question of finding meaning in your work, workplace quality of life, and so on. Those are things you don't learn in engineering school! We need tools and perspective to broach these topics and detect pain points, hence the need for new training."

/ MY HEROES

Launched in the spring of 2022 as part of the *FEEL GOOD TOGETHER* plan, the *MY HEROES* programme means to urge employees to participate in sport, for employee wellness, team cohesion, and connection between our various sites. Interview with programme lead Marion and Gerlinde, a "super-user" of the dedicated app.

Marion Talent Acquisition and Development Manager based in Saint-Cyr-au-Mont-d'Or (France)

*"All group employees have access to the United Heroes app that offers inspiring wellness-related content: articles about walking or running, nutritional advice, etc.
Using an app makes the programme more accessible and fun. Employees can record their performance and collect points by completing individual or group sports challenges.
Every activity translates to health points, which are then converted to donations we make to organisations that support environmental and social causes.
For example, in September 2022, we set up a sports challenge (MY HEROES: Move for the Planet!) aimed at collecting as many points as possible to help protect the environment.
Every activity point was converted into donations to an organisation dedicated to protecting the planet."*

Gerlinde Data Protection Manager based in Veitshoechheim, Germany, (NKM Noell Special Cranes) and super-user of the MY HEROES app

"I have used the app since it was first launched across the group. In the program, I can access new weekly challenges, which encourages me to be physically active. The challenges are both varied (support for Ukranian refugees, the environment, promotion of soft mobility, etc.) and appealing. Seeing the names of colleagues in other countries appear in the app spurs me on!"

/ AWARE *(ACCELERATE WOMEN AT REEL)*: THE MARCH OF FEMINISATION

Forty-five employees, men and women alike, joined the CEO-founded Aware club meant to promote gender diversity within the group. Its goal: to take action, both within REEL and externally, to attract, support, and promote a growing number of women in technical, scientific, and management fields and leverage the diversity they bring. Since it's not about opposing genders, two women and one man tell us about their commitment: Amandine, Julie, and Cédric.

Amandine Business Activity Export & New Business Manager for BU IBP

"I decided to join the Aware programme because in my previous position, I had the opportunity to be mentored by a group executive. I appreciated the fact that my mentor was a woman, since she understood my concerns and obstacles.
For example, when applying for a new assignment, women will self-censor themselves, feeling that they need to meet 80% of the requirements of the position profile, while men will believe their claim is legitimate when they meet 30% or 40%! There is real work to be done in this area: we have to break the biases that spread through society, the media, and even education sometimes. It was why I participated in a group presentation to ECAM, to show women all the potential in family-based industrial businesses like REEL. I have been a part of the group for 4 years and I have never experienced the least bit of sexism. And since women naturally foster consensual approaches (which is not to say they lack in firmness!), their presence is a real asset for management, one which the company has to harness."

Julie Executive Director, REEL Alesa Montréal

"For a long time, I was the only woman in Alesa's mechanical business, but I think that being a man or a woman makes no difference as long as you are passionate about what you do. In every position I have had the opportunity to hold throughout the group, I was always welcomed and I could always express myself freely. I have been a project manager, spares coordinator, sales coordinator, and business director, and my bosses have always been receptive when it came to work-life balance. REEL listens to its employees, both men and women, and their aspirations often overlap. So when we received the email introducing the Aware initiative and upper management's intent to feminise the workforce, we were already in the process of recruiting 3 young engineers. We had already selected the two young women who had the best resumes and interviews. We were ahead of the curve! Given the unfamiliarity of our industry, we have to reach out to very young audiences as part of Aware to appeal to women. Our action plan has yet to be defined, but we are considering sponsoring teams of women or mixed teams at university games in the fields of mechanics or robotics. It would be a great way to generate visibility for our company and highlight our ability to welcome more women among us!"

Cédric Deputy CEO, REEL Group

"Even though I don't consider REEL to be a sexist company, the numbers don't lie: with women making up only 13% of our workforce, when they make up 22% of the larger metallurgy industry, our organisation is definitely showing a deficit. We are facing major recruitment issues for the future, and we have to be able to attract female talents. It's also a factor in corporate development and continuity. A study that ran from 2007 to 2016 showed that the highest-performing companies of the CAC 40 were also those with the most highly feminised management. A feminisation threshold of 35% is required before the minority can begin to have a real effect on decision-making. I think that the gender equality index, which currently stands at 84% in France, reveals the company's maturity level when it comes to equal treatment. What we must do now is attract and promote more women in the group, without calling into question the concept of skills, which is the basis of our internal promotions.
That is why I am part of the Aware club. My role is to ensure that we walk the talk – that our beliefs align with the real world in the field and the actions we take within the group. If we want to feminise our hierarchy going forward, we have to set up mentoring and coaching policies to encourage women to apply for high-responsibility positions. They need time to grow their visibility and develop their own network across the company; we can give them the opportunity to travel throughout the organisation or international mobility assignments. This approach has already led to some progress: we are now looking ahead and anticipating future replacements for site or plant managers over a period of 2 or 3 years. By bringing together the women in our organisation, the Aware club will act as a catalyst for these initiatives, inspiring and revealing women of talent."

/ GOVERNANCE

Originally a small metallurgical company, now grown into a medium-sized business and a recognized player in several industries, our governance has always operated under the triple sign of respect, entrepreneurial spirit, and long-term vision.

/ OUR ACTIONS

Respect

Key marker of our values, respect forms the backdrop of everything we do. It's about respecting our customers and suppliers, with the humility that guides our return on experience process ans drives a continuous learning attitude. It's about our upper management and family shareholders respecting employees, which was recently reflected in the decision to open up to employee shareholding. It's also about respecting our competition through our ethics.

Entrepreneurial spirit

From the early days of our industrial adventure (sales revenue of 4 M€ in 1971, 40 M€ in 1996, and 400 M€ in 2020), there has always been a sense of opportunity, courage, and daring – that's entrepreneurial spirit! Dependent on the nuclear industry for 90% of our business at the start, it also took entrepreneurial spirit to diversify into entirely new business lines and industries, reducing our dependency to about a third of our business.

This spirit now reflects in group research and development serving our customers or renewable energy markets.

Today, we are organised into divisions, business units, and business lines, each of them being headed by entrepreneurs.
More than ever, maintaining an optimal balance between autonomy (enabling initiatives) and the development of standardised rules and practices (a must for larger-scale groups) is a daily challenge.

Long-term vision

Family share ownership is a strength for the group when it comes to long-term vision, prioritising strategic long-term decisions over short-term and a governance ensuring the continuity of family ownership.

Remaining independent

When you compare the group's sales revenue curve, which reflects times of crisis, and its workforce curve, which shows steady growth, the decision to prioritise strategic guidelines over short-term profits is obvious. We have seen our share of crises: the sub-primes of 2008, the impact of Fukushima in 2011, the crash of offshore and oil prices in 2014, COVID in 2020, and most recently, the loss of new aluminium projects in Russia due to the war. We have shown resilience, thanks to the diversity of our businesses, geographic footprint, and the resources we share between businesses. It is also thanks to shareholders that we retained our skills and resources over these crisis. The future has always proven these long-term choices right.

Sustaining the family ownership that makes these choices possible depends mainly on group performance, which ensures our financial independence. It is the primary point of the group's strategy. Despite the many acquisitions we have made in the last few years, we have had more cash than debt at any point in time.

This continuity also depends on a governance that ensures the role of the board of directors outlives individuals. We have opted for the most demanding standards and practices. For example, the Group's board of directors includes three distinct subgroups: a strategy and innovation committee, an audit, ethics and compliance committee, and an appointment and compensation committee. All three are chaired by independent people recognized for their extensive professional experience.

Their role and prerogative is to challenge the group's operational management teams on an ongoing basis and to prepare board of directors decisions. They ensure that risk identification and mitigation mechanisms, and processes that ensure group rules and procedures are adequate, and they provide strategic guidelines.

Continuity and risk management

On the REEL International executive committee sit the CEO, two Deputy CEOs, five Division Directors, the Director of Industrial Performance and Purchasing, and three representatives from support functions (HR, Finance & IS, and Compliance, Legal, Risk, and Insurance).
The CEO trio's mission involves working on group strategy, tracking performance, and bringing on independant risk analysis on major projects right from the offer stage.

Aligned with the group's strategic development, this organisation reflects both a generational shift and a priority given to internal promotion.
It aims to retain the group's financial independence, so as to ensure preserving the medium and long term vision, by preserving the group's entrepreneurial spirit – including a *"focus on products/markets and close proximity with customers,"* says Marie-France.

KEY FIGURE
33%
OF WOMEN
ON THE BOARD

To celebrate 75 years of REEL, executive committee members travelled to most sites to meet group employees.
Every member of the executive committee met with a dozen employees to discuss their current and future concerns.

/ EMPLOYEE SHAREHOLDING: A WELL-PRAISED, SUCCESSFUL OPERATION

In May 2022, we offered our employees the opportunity to buy into a mutual fund, enabling them to become group shareholders. In a show of directly connecting employees and the benefits of growth, the operation to open capital was a great success.

Created in 1946, REEL has always been a family company, held mainly by the descendants of its founder, Charles Frantz. Born in a modest workshop in a suburb of Lyon, the company grew over seventy-five years into an international group in sound financial health. Willing to connect employees directly to this success, family shareholders decided to offer employees the opportunity to become group shareholders[1]. To do so, they opened up approximately 3% of REEL International's capital.

The operation led in May 2022 was realised through the creation of a corporate mutual fund known as MY SHARE REEL. In accordance with the current regulatory system, the share value was calculated by an independent expert and the valuation method was submitted to financial market authority AMF for approval. Employees who so desired could then purchase shares in the mutual fund, either by investing incentives in whole or in part or by making a voluntary payment. Purchasing terms were very favourable: the group offered a 20% discount on the share price, along with a contribution for all amounts invested.
A contribution limit was set to ensure everyone could take part. At the conclusion of the campaign, nearly 50% of eligible employees had become indirect REEL shareholders, with the mutual fund holding REEL International shares reserved for employee purchase. "In the end, demand exceeded the offer, and we had to raise the contribution limit," says Philippe Frantz. *"We are proud of this expression of trust. In general, this type of operation in France garners a positive response from about one third of employees."*

For Philippe Frantz, this access to capital is part of the wider concept of profit sharing, *"sharing results that has long existed within REEL's French entities. Beyond mandatory participation, we long ago set up a profit sharing agreement and corporate savings plan. Establishing the mutual fund completes the process. It makes it possible for everyone across the group to harvest the benefits of growth."*
Stéphane, Purchasing Manager for the Nantes and La Rochelle sites, agrees: *"We invest a lot of ourselves in what we do every day; owning REEL shares reflects that investment, in a certain way."*
Stéphane has worked for the group for fifteen years and he has always seen the bold and diligent approach that has helped it realise ambitious projects. Buying into the mutual fund seemed like an interesting and logical opportunity to become involved in the group's future. *"It's not a short-term approach, and it demonstrates employee belief in the continued success of REEL,"* he explains, before concluding mischievously: *"By becoming shareholders, we have the feeling we are no longer just tenants: it's like we've bought part of the walls of the house!"*
Taking a keen interest in the operation, he applied to be an employee representative on the supervisory board of the mutual fund[2]. The role of this body is advisory, but important: *"We are expected to review the management report and annual accounts of the mutual fund, and one of us sits at the REEL International general shareholders' meeting."*

1 - In the first phase, only employees of group entities in France, Germany, Switzerland, and Canada (i.e. over 90% of employees) were eligible. Feasibility studies are underway for other countries.

2 - The board is made up of 3 members representing the group and appointed by upper management, and 3 elected members representing employee shareholders.

/ ETHICS AND COMPLIANCE: ESSENTIAL COMPONENTS OF RESPONSIBLE GROWTH

While the group has always stood firmly against reprehensible acts, France's adoption of the "Sapin II" law regarding transparency, the fight against corruption, and the modernisation of economic life in 2016, gave new momentum to our actions in the area of ethics and compliance, their formalization and cascading across all our entities.
The new organisation set up in 2021 also nominated a compliance, legal, risk, and insurance Director within the executive committee. A look back at REEL's ethics and compliance evolution with Jean-Molf, who leads this department.

Ethics and compliance: key topics since 2016

Although we have handled these topics for many years within the group through the officialisation of company values in the early 2000s and the implementation of an employee code of ethics and code of conduct a few years later, the topic has come to the forefront since 2016.
At REEL International, compliance first focussed on the fight against corruption, beyond the development of a whistleblower process, and the training of teams.
"We must be alert to acts that could take place within our organisation, in France and abroad, and to issues our customers face. What matters to them also matters to us. At the same time, acquisition due diligences have taken a closer look at these topics," says Jean-Molf, before adding, *"The growth of my scope of responsibility illustrates this evolution and the growing importance of these topics within REEL, as well as the company's desire to address ethics and compliance close to upper management."*

The ethics commission and reporting system

Since 2016, a reporting system using a dedicated email and an ethics commission have been set up **(ethics@reel.fr)** in a way that ensures the confidentiality of whistleblowers. While the obligation initially involved fighting corruption, we quickly decided to expand its scope regarding the commitments and values we embedded in the REEL code of ethics, which is available on the group's website and intranet.
It also makes it possible to collect any reports for psychological or sexual harassment and supports the increasing attention given to questions involving export controls, international sanctions, or CFSI[1] (Counterfeit, Fraudulent and Suspect Items) by recording all escalated reports.
"The whistleblower system can escalate information on a wide range of subjects related to corruption, potential cases of discrimination or harassment, or the interpretation of our gift policy, for example.
Every report made by a named or anonymous individual, from within the company or external to it, is investigated by the ethics commission," mentions Jean-Molf.
"The ethics commission is meant to ensure better managerial representation, so it is made up of representatives from upper management, our divisions, and our main foreign subsidiaries.
This body is tasked with supporting and guiding employees in abiding by applicable internal rules and handling reports in the event of potential misconduct," explains Jean-Molf.

Team communication, awareness, training, and consultation for better risk management

When it comes to training and awareness, ethics flashes on questions about harassment and discrimination are held regularly. Human Resources has also set up manager training on psychosocial risks.
More than 400 employees in 15 countries completed the KPMG corruption risk awareness e-learning in 2022. Based on real-life cases, the training is available in English and French in the REEL Academy catalogue. *"The list of people targeted by the awareness campaign was determined based on their possible exposure. The entire executive team, members of the group's board of directors, all middle managers, functions deemed critical, including Purchasing, and every country with low Transparency International[2] corruption perception scores received more specific training. We also trained all employees in the four entities that joined the group in 2021 after our recent acquisitions,"* says Jean-Molf. The 2022 update of the corruption risk mapping made a deep-dive analysis possible and connected with many employees.
Over 10 themed workshops were facilitated by PwC in the leadup to a risk classification. A custom questionnaire was then sent out to 200 employees. A second series of workshops helped refine the ranking of risks, with the mapping meant to be used as the backbone in the development of action plans. *"The implementation of the European directive on whistleblowers by the members of the EU coincides with this new mapping and efforts to strengthen our reporting system and ensure compliance,"* says Jean-Molf.

1 - Counterfeit, Fraudulent and Suspect Items (CFSI) include intentionally falsified items.

2 - Since 1995, NGO Transparency International has published an annual corruption perceptions index (CPI) that ranks countries according to their perceived levels of corruption.

REEL contributes
to the ITER project

/ DEVELOPING LOW-CARBON ENERGY PROJECTS WITH STAKEHOLDERS

As mentioned in the synthesis report of the IPCC's sixth assessment report, approximately 34% of greenhouse gas emissions worldwide in 2019 were attributable to the energy sector, and 24% to industry. Decarbonising industry is a major global challenge that we must help fight by designing and implementing better solutions that help our customers lessen the environmental footprint of their businesses. That means mobilising our expertise and know-how to act on factors including continuous improvement (energy efficiency, changes in fuel sources, mechanical recycling), frugality, and technological disruption. This ability will also engage our ability to innovate in driving projects that combine environmental performance and economic viability.

/ OUR ACTIONS

A longstanding presence in low-carbon energy

As climate change imposes an energy revolution, we are leveraging the trust of longstanding players to develop new solutions that optimise decarbonised energy production.
We have been working in the nuclear industry since its inception in France in the 60s, and throughout the country's major nuclear power plant construction programme, beginning in Fessenheim in the 70s where we manufactured the refuelling machine. We have since supported the implementation of nuclear reactors around the world – in Finland, China, the United Kingdom, and France – and now, EPR2 and SMR, for which delivery and equipment commissioning are set for 2030-2035.
Since 1996, we have also been present in the hydroelectric industry through our REEL COH and MC Levage entities. We offer a range of complete heavy lifting and handling solutions (new or overhaul) that ensure the proper operation of hydro dams.

Solutions to optimise industrial processes and their life cycles

The Aluminium division designs and installs new and revamped equipment to lower the energy consumption and emissions generated in the production of aluminium: more fuel-efficient electrolysis machines, gas treatment centres that suction and process pollutants (hydrogen fluoride) generated by potlines during alumina electrolysis, CO_2 trapping, and solutions to lower carbonised emissions. Optimisation projects are driven by our dedicated Environmental Control Solutions business line.
In every market we do business, we make sure to implement processes that optimise facility maintenance and extend the service life of operating equipment.

Supporting innovative markets

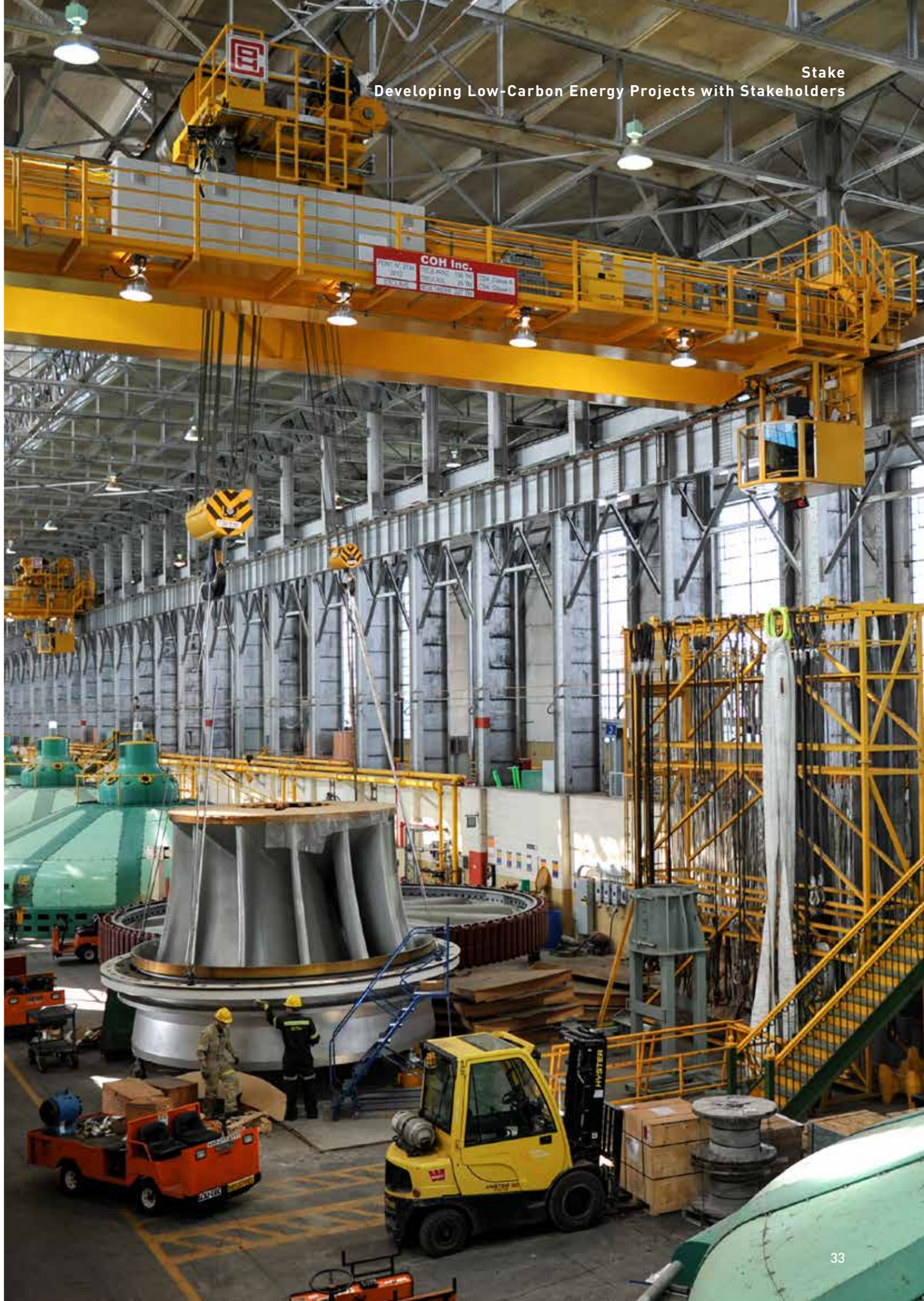
We have partnered with startups as co-developers to improve the reliability and complete the industrialisation of disruptive technology that uses renewable energy or facilitates its production.
To support such innovative projects over the long term, we have set up dedicated entities:

> The Wind Products business line helps drive the rise in wind propulsion for cargo ships, in a bid to lower maritime transportation GHG emissions.
> The Environmental Control Solutions (ECS) business line develops handling technology specific to biomass-based power stations.
> REEL Imeca is investigating new methods to install and maintain wind turbines in deep waters.

An integrated environmental approach

Beyond the innovation of emergent markets, we strive to call into question the conventional processes inherent to our every project: design, purchasing, on-site equipment delivery, installation, commissioning, and maintenance.
One way to make progress involves integrating ecodesign to optimise equipment weight and material footprint, improve intrinsic energy performance, and mitigate the impact of transportation to customer sites. Ecodesign is one of the topics that will be added to our next Group Innovation Challenge in 2024. Project emissions will be assessed using an evaluation tool that is being developed and will undergo proof of concept in 2023.
The integrated approach will eventually help lower the environmental footprint of group business over its entire value chain.

KEY FIGURE
33%
OF BUSINESS IS IN LOW-CARBON ENERGY



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HELPING LOWER GREENHOUSE GAS EMISSIONS IN THE OFFSHORE AND MARITIME INDUSTRIES

Zoom in on 3 projects at different levels of development: pile grippers, suction wings, and kites.

MARITIME WIND POWER

Wind as an energy source

Using wind is one of the cleanest and most sustainable ways of generating electric power. Today, offshore wind turbines produce nearly 70 gigawatts of power. By 2050, that could grow to 1,750 gigawatts. Offshore wind turbines are growing in both size and power. They are installed increasingly far from shore to harness more powerful and constant winds. That helps make it a more affordable energy source and lower its CO_2 emissions per kWh. *"We have focussed on the installation of mono-piles, the widest-used foundation to anchor turbines to the sea floor. In order to keep up with wind turbine size and a target sea floor depth of 65 meters, we designed a versatile pile gripper for mono-piles 6.5 to 13 meters in diameter and up to 120 meters in length. The project poses many challenges, including developing a safe and reliable solution to keep XXL mono-piles vertical in all operational phases. It requires extreme precision and responsiveness for such a large-scale machine,"* says Éric, Director of the Aeronautics, Marine and Industry Division.
We are currently manufacturing our first pile gripper. *"The pile gripper is undergoing final assembly at the port in La Rochelle and will soon be outfitted onto a ship. It is a floating vessel, rather than the jack-up vessels traditionally used for offshore installation, to do away with depth limitations and deal with the storage and lifting requirements of longer, heavier mono piles. We expect it will cut down on installation time by a factor of 2.5. Our motion-compensated pile gripper prevents mono piles from oscillating during descent and keeps them vertical during piledriving, compensating for horizontal vessel motion,"* explains Éric. A dozen more floating vessels specialised for mono pile installation will be required by 2030.

Maintenance: facilitating and securing maintenance operations on offshore wind turbines

"Wind farms have to be inspected regularly and maintained. Their growing numbers encourage the delivery of specific support vessels with a hundred or so maintenance technicians on board. Their secure transfer between the vessel and wind turbine platform, as well as the transfer of parts, is made possible by a gangway and crane that compensate for the vessel's motion. Our unique skills in this field helped us secure a first contract," concludes Éric.

WIND PROPULSION OF MERCHANT SHIPS

In line with Paris Accord targets, the International Maritime Organisation calls for a 40% reduction in CO_2 and greenhouse gas emissions from 2008 levels by 2030, and at least 50% by 2050. We are contributing to this climate imperative with the support of our ecosystem of partners.

Suction wing

In 2021, French research centre for nautical architecture and industry CRAIN reached out to us to update a concept developed by Commander Cousteau in the 80s. The French explorer had installed two vertical wings on the deck of his ship to propel it forward, thus saving fuel and helping lower GHG (10% to 25% improvement to date). The research centre was looking for a solid industrial partner that could both design and build these vertical wings, then bring the project to market. The wings act as an auxiliary propulsion system. *"Suction wings work like wings on an aircraft, with flaps that form an asymmetrical profile featuring an upper and lower surface and that turn to face apparent wind. Since it is a "thick" profile, we have to "suction" the boundary layer of air to press it against the profile and generate a very significant pull force. Positioned vertically on the deck of a ship, it provides propulsive force,"* explained François, Director of the Wind Products Business Line. The first full-scale prototype should be launched in late 2023.

Airseas

The Airseas startup, specialised in supporting maritime decarbonisation by transposing aeronautical expertise to ships, reached out to us in 2018 for its namesake project.
It is a wind propulsion system that involves launching a large kite, some several hundred square meters in size, to harness upper-level winds. The winds create strong traction against the sail, the force of which is transferred to the ship itself. It is estimated that using wind power in this way can lower fuel consumption by 15% to 20%. *"Airseas was looking for a well-established industrial partner that could bring the right level of skill and know-how to design and build the kite launcher and recovery system. We conducted the engineering studies for this deck-based auxiliary propulsion system that contributes to ships' energy mix. Our teams in La Rochelle designed and assembled the first two full-scale prototypes,"* said François.

"The technology developed with Airseas combines mechanics, controls, automation, and hydraulics. The project called on our every expertise! The first system has been at sea since late 2021. The second system, installed on the ship of Airseas' first customer in Japan, will undergo testing in 2023." added François. The next step involves bringing the innovative technology to market. *"It is a very ambitious roadmap, given volume and cost issues,"* he concludes.

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EPR2: NUCLEAR POWER IN THE AGE OF ENERGY TRANSITION

Since it provides constantly available, low-carbon power, nuclear energy has regained a place of choice in France's energy mix, as defined by the President of the Republic in his speech in Belfort on February 10, 2023. Six EPR2 reactors have already been confirmed, and more should soon be included in the program to renew French nuclear fleet. As a longstanding partner of EDF, the world's largest provider of nuclear electricity, we are already taking part in this large-scale project to strengthen France's position as a low-carbon electric power generator. Premises and promises for the future with Olivier and David.

Adapting energy to climate-driven constraints

Nuclear power has two intrinsic qualities that make it a useful tool in the energy revolution required to tackle climate change. First, it can generate large amounts of electric power: its output can be measured in gigawatts, while hydraulic and wind-based facilities produce on a megawatt scale. Second, generating such power does not produce CO_2, whose dominant role in climat change. Along with extending the service life of currently operational power plants, the French government has opted for an overhaul program that should lead to the production of new reactors by 2035.

The implementation of the first 6 reactors is planned on existing nuclear sites, both to optimise reserves of land pre-empted by EDF and to use existing high-voltage power lines. Selected sites are Penly in Normandy, Gravelines in Hauts-de-France, and Bugey in Auvergne-Rhône-Alpes.

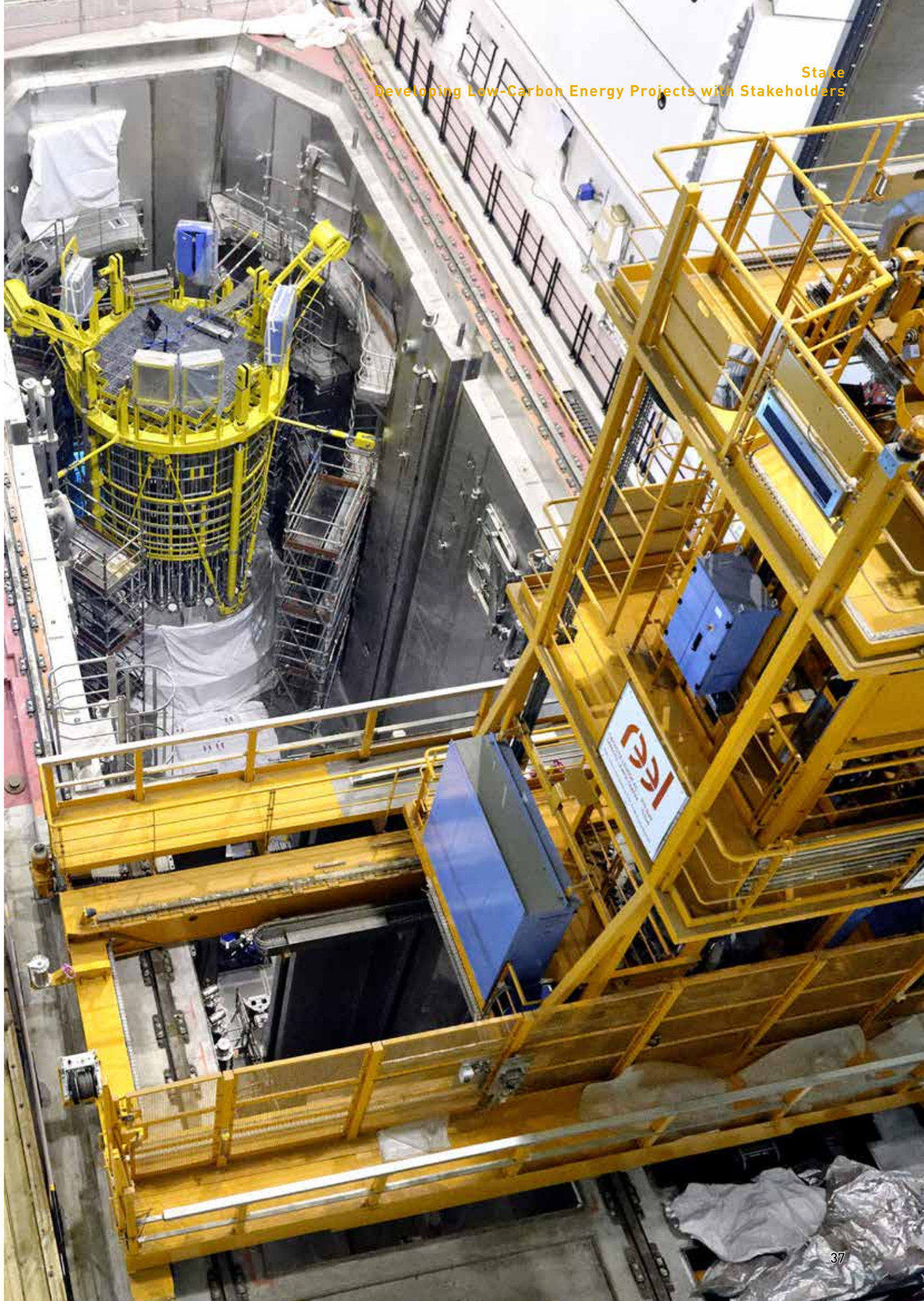
A renewed approach

"The philosophy guiding the development of this new generation of power plants, known as European Pressurized Reactors, or EPR2, is optimisation," begins Olivier, Deputy CEO responsible for the group's nuclear business. "EDF wants to leverage the lessons learned from the first EPR construction projects. The first objective is to develop reactors that are less complex in design, so they are simpler to build and operate, and therefore less costly overall while meeting the same safety requirements. The second objective of the programme is to adopt a more industrial, serialised approach. EDF is challenging all its partners to find robust technical solutions that can be industrialised to reach its financial performance targets at the same high safety level.

We are ideally positioned to support the infrastructure renewal program, as we have developed a trusted partnership with EDF over the years, based on our commitment to preserving the engineering and manufacturing skills and resources needed to reach such long-term objectives. We demonstrate strong technical performance when it comes to nuclear fuel handling and we have extended these success stories to other operations, such as heat sinks. The fact that we control the entire value chain, from design and manufacturing to installation and maintenance, is also keenly appreciated by customers as an assurance to the quality of our work.
Our internal RedOx process that promotes design to cost and industrialisation fits in perfectly with EPR2 programme objectives.
Our teams are working actively to optimise fuel handling and storage equipment. For example, we already have innovative ideas to standardise certain pieces of equipment, moving from 17 models to 2, or maybe even a single one. That is a dual win in terms of efficiency and simplicity."

Involved stakeholders

"Challenges in launching new EPR2 overlap with those of our CSR policy, which is no coincidence," adds David, Director of the Nuclear Production Division. *"From a social standpoint, the French nuclear industry, both operators and suppliers, currently employs 220,000 people in all. Recent studies show that the industry will have to recruit to fill 100,000 positions in the next ten years. That is massive. The industry is making tremendous efforts to draw students to the industry and its trades. We are doing our part, as our Nuclear business units are onboarding a growing number of work-study students with a two or three-year technical degree profile. That is but one aspect of many we could name."*



/ NUCLEAR SAFETY: A CULTURE WRITTEN IN THE COMPANY'S DNA

A key player in the nuclear industry, both in France and abroad, we play a role in nuclear facility processes, as a manufacturer or maintainer. To ensure maximum safety in the facilities where we operate, we have developed a nuclear safety culture that coordinates the awareness and involvement of every stakeholder throughout the organisation. Perspectives from Olivier, Deputy CEO responsible for the nuclear safety committee, and Nicolas, QHSE Director.

Every year, the French nuclear safety authority assesses the nuclear industry's ability to handle the challenges of national policy.
While the responsibility of ensuring facility safety lies with nuclear operators, our business keeps us deeply involved in safety issues, from design and manufacturing to installation and maintenance.
We have to make sure we are in full control of safety concerns in everything we do. We have stood side-by-side with our customers for years to define, organise, and maintain the highest-level requirements throughout the organisation. As a result, we have already redefined our nuclear safety policy.

Developing a safety culture

"Nuclear safety rests on 3 pillars: the skills of those involved, the efficiency of work organisation, i.e. our quality management system and the reliability of equipment," says Nicolas. *"Safety cannot be decreed. It rests on the awareness of every individual stakeholder throughout the entire organisation. Obviously, those who work in the power plants themselves experience nuclear safety on a daily basis, but others, remote from sensitive sites, may forget that they also have a role to play in safety when they design or build a simple part that will become part of an assembly to be installed in a confined space. Everyone has to remain constantly aware that there are consequences to their gestures. That's why we hold regular nuclear safety awareness campaigns for everyone involved in the nuclear business, from the day new hires are recruited and at least every three years for current personnel. We have the same approach with suppliers! Over 1,000 people in all have undergone our induction module in one year."*

Structured supervision

"Our nuclear safety committee meets every quarter, and we analyse, process, and share all events and warnings escalated over the last period. Thanks to our network of nuclear safety representatives across all group entities involved in the nuclear business, we have continuous feedback from the field," explains Olivier. "Our nuclear safety committee also helps us implement best practices in safety control throughout the entire organisation. Transparency is one of the pillars of nuclear safety culture. That's why we want to remind you that the REEL ethics committee can be reached at ethics@reel.fr to report any lapse, including in nuclear safety. Safety is a requirement, a prerequisite to conducting nuclear business, and we all share an obligation. Diligence, knowledge and application of procedures, questioning approach – these are all keywords and necessary behaviours for our nuclear operations.
The nuclear industry has instituted ISO 19443, a nuclear-specific certification. Our engineering and project management activities are already certified, and our plants will be certified in 2023. The next stage will involve supporting our suppliers who also wish to achieve certification but are unable to do so on their own. Our responsibility does not stop with our customers – it also extends to control over our supply chain."

** France's Autorité de Sureté Nucléaire is an independent body that acts on the State's behalf to ensure nuclear safety and radiation protection control, protecting people and the environment.*

Definition of nuclear safety per France's INB decree/Article L591-1

"Nuclear safety covers all technical provisions and organisation measures related to the design, manufacturing, operation, stoppage, and dismantling of basic nuclear facilities and the transportation of radioactive substances, and taken to prevent accidents or limit their effects."

/ HYDROELECTRICITY: RENEWABLE FLOWS FROM THE SOURCE

Hydroelectricity generated by facilities over waterways, lakes, or man-made reservoirs, is a long-known and controlled form of renewable energy. The proximity of our facilities to major bodies of water has helped us develop essential expertise for operators of what has simply come to be called hydro. Viewpoints of a pair of experts on either side of the Atlantic: Sébastien D, Executive Director of REEL North America and Sébastien G, Director for BL services Rhône-Alpes.

On the North American shores of the Atlantic

Hydroelectricity is a key industry for our REEL COH subsidiary, which joined the group in 1996. *"Material for the hydro power industry makes up almost 50% of our business. We have developed a specialty in floodgate gantry cranes for dams and powerhouse cranes, but that's not all…"* explains Sébastien. *"Historically, we began in the 80s in the province of Québec, which has a huge production network it began building in the 70s. In 2010, our reputation crossed the border, and USACE (US Army Corps of Engineers), which oversees all US dams, called on us. We kept accumulating success stories, and projects kept growing in size: our largest to date is a 600-tonne gantry crane we installed at the John Day Dam in Oregon in 2020. With new facilities growing more infrequent – although we are working on a major gantry crane project with New York Port Authorities, the entity responsible for the state's hydroelectric power supply – most of our business involves replacing machines that were installed 30 to 50 years ago. Since hydroelectricity remains the most sustainable energy resource to date, we are very mindful of growing our expertise in that area!"*

On the old continent

Our involvement in the area of hydroelectricity dates back to the 2000s and is the result of a collaboration with two longstanding customers. *"We began in 2007 with EDF on the replacement of cofferdam gantry cranes in Ottmasheim,"* observes Sébastien. *"After our first experience, we obtained customer qualification for gate* renovation operations. In 2010, we responded to a call for proposals for the renovation of 4 bridge cranes in the machine room of the Génissiat Dam on the Rhône. That was how we renewed our partnership with CNR (Compagnie Nationale du Rhône), which became our main customer in the industry and for our agency as a whole.*
We recently strengthened the relation with a contract for multi-year expertise and maintenance for all its lifting and handling equipment. We are concurrently working on major renovation and replacement projects for cranes, gantry cranes, and screen rakes."

** Gates: The various types of gates and floodgates that allow water to enter lock chambers, keep it there, or release it, regulating the flow rate.*

/ DECARBONISING THE ALUMINIUM INDUSTRY

Beyond the upstream impact of extraction, there are two major considerations when it comes to producing aluminium. The first is the nature of the power used to run smelters: some rely on green or low-carbon forms, like hydro or nuclear power, while others use natural gas or coal. In the latter case, generating electric power releases substantial amounts of CO_2 from burning fossil fuels. The second consideration relates to the aluminium production process, which itself generates CO_2.

Avoiding fossil fuels and extracting raw material

We offer a range of products and processes to help our customers lower their production-related CO2 emissions. However, as aluminium is a highly recyclable material that can be melted down many times over, some of our customers already use recycled aluminium along with primary metal. *"Average figures of CO2 emissions generated to produce one tonne of aluminium mask large disparities between companies and locations. The lowest values are attainable through the use of recycled aluminium and green electric power. But the industry as a whole knows it has to evolve. The customer base of aluminium smelters, such as the automotive industry, is now calling for the use of aluminium with a low carbon footprint. We support these changes through the equipment, machines, and processes we design for customers,"* explains Patrik, Director of the Aluminium Division.

Potential solutions

The Aluminium Division offers various solutions. *"First, we are developing more efficient and less energy-consuming solutions that improve the energy performance of facilities. For several years, we have been designing and installing pneumatic electrolysis pot feeders that limit anode effect and optimise potline efficiency. We also provide pot control units that improve operations and aluminium production efficiency.*
As part of a new plant project, we chose to use locally available raw materials to reduce the carbon footprint of transportation operations.
One of the most promising levers involves carbon capture, i.e. extracting gas from electrolytic cells and concentrating off-gases up to a certain point, in order to capture CO_2 as far down the integrated process as possible. Our teams are motivated and dedicated to finding solutions to reduce the carbon footprint of the aluminium industry," concludes Patrik.

/ REDUCING OUR ENVIRONMENTAL FOOTPRINT

We are an international industrial organisation, and our impact is proportional to our operational levels. To coordinate efforts across our various entities. we have defined a decarbonisation strategy and pathway that aligns with Paris Accord targets (1.5 °C).
The first step involves determining our carbon footprint across the largest possible scope.

/ OUR ACTIONS

Enhancing the reliability of the group's environmental management system

There are currently several proven methods to evaluate our environmental footprint. We intend to raise our Carbon Disclosure Project (CDP) rating from the current C to B- by 2025.
Seven group sites are currently ISO 14001 certified.

Controlling site energy consumption

Power consumption at head office has been reduced by 50% through changes in air conditioning units and the transition to LED lighting. Our industrial sites in Nantes, Villefranche-sur-Saône, and La Rochelle are also equipped with LED lighting. The replacement programme will extend progressively to other entities, along with the implementation and rollout of an electric consumption control system. We intend to fully equip all French sites with LED lighting by 2023, and our other facilities around the world by late 2025. To favour the use of renewable energy and self-supply in our buildings, we are planning to install solar panels on industrial sites and large office buildings: Villefranche-sur-Saône and the head office in Saint-Cyr will serve as pilot project in 2023, before expanding to other plants and large sites.

Minimising office waste

We have eliminated plastic cups from all our facilities. Paper usage dropped by 30% between 2019 and 2022. Water use is being streamlined with the end of plastic bottles. All our sites send their computer terminals to recycling facilities, and our French facilities also recycle mobile devices.

Reducing transportation-related emissions

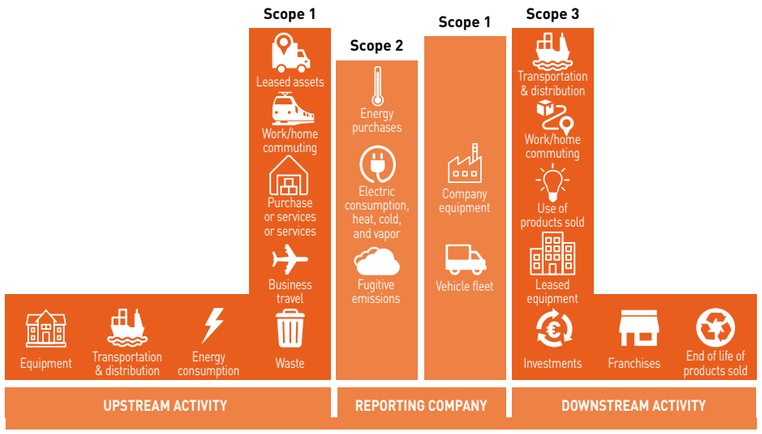
The first milestone of our roadmap called for a consolidated view of employee travel to suggest potential improvements:
> Encouraging carpooling through a dedicated app for each country (a version is already available in France and will be modernised).
> Progressively replacing the fleet of service vehicles with electric vehicles.
> Installing charging stations at our various entities.

Manager and employee-led field initiatives are multiplying, as shown in the following pages.

Assessing the carbon footprint of our equipment

We began developing a tool to calculate the carbon footprint of our projects over their entire life cycle (design, manufacturing, transportation, installation, commissioning, operation, and dismantling). The goal is to identify areas for optimisation and suggest less impactful alternatives to our stakeholders. The pilot project is steered by our Environmental Control Solutions (ECS) Business Line for our Aluminium business in 2023, before deploying it across operations in other group businesses and divisions starting in 2024.

KEY FIGURE
1769 KWH
AVERAGE RATIO OF ELECTRIC POWER/ EMPLOYEE IN FRANCE



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ASSESSING THE CARBON FOOTPRINT OF OUR EQUIPMENT

In a bid to suggest more environmentally friendly alternatives to our customers, we have begun developing an internal tool to calculate the carbon footprint of group-led projects. This pilot project is led by our Environmental Control Solutions (ECS) Business Line, which specialises in designing, manufacturing, and installing gas treatment systems for aluminium production.

Guillaume Deputy Director of ECS

As an equipment supplier for the aluminium industry, which generates large amounts of greenhouse gases, we are considering different ways to support our customers in decarbonising their operations, such as aluminium production.

Producing one tonne of aluminium currently generates between 2.5 and over 15 tonnes of CO_2, depending on the company and geographic location. This carbon footprint includes direct emissions from the plant, as well as emissions related to generating the electric power needed for aluminium production.
The latter are said to be indirect, as they are emitted by the power plant. In most cases, indirect emissions represent the largest portion of the plant's carbon footprint. For plants located in countries where electric power comes from low-carbon sources, such as France, Canada, or Norway, the portion of indirect emissions is lower, and the plant's carbon footprint is at the lower end of the spectrum (between 2.5 and 5 tonnes of CO_2/tonne of aluminium).

While there are considerable disparities, the industry as a whole has realised the need to update its model and significantly lower its emissions. *"The tool we are currently developing is grounded in the goal of producing the lowest-carbon aluminium that we can, depending on the specific context of each customer. We have called on the expertise of a a specialized consulting firm to start the process using proper, credible methodology,"* explains Guillaume.

The first stage of the pilot project involves using a real-world example – a gas treatment centre that processes electrolysis pot off-gases – to identify the most significant sources of emissions. The scope covers an analysis of the entire life cycle of the equipment, from its design phase to manufacturing, installation, operation, and dismantling. *"90% of emissions stem from the GTC's power consumption over its entire life cycle, which is at least 25 years. The nature of the power source used, whether fossil fuel-based or renewable, is decisive. The first aspect we can act on directly is to imagine facilities that use less power or generate fewer emissions during operation. It is not about sweeping other considerations aside, even though they weigh less in the overall balance, since they remain significant in absolute terms. For example, manufacturing equipment requires raw materials, the extraction and origin of which can have a considerable impact,"* notes Guillaume. *"The consulting firm is helping us to build the tools and collect the data we need to ensure its reliability, particularly in terms of defining emission factors for raw materials. Two steel suppliers can have very different footprints, and choosing a greener supplier can help us reduce our own footprint. The firm is also tasked with assessing the emission factors of other inputs and processes we use. For example, 50,000 hours of engineering work generates GHG emissions directly, such as heating the building, but also indirectly through the necessary plane travel involved. The engineering phase therefore presents an opportunity to lower our impact,"* he adds. Aligning with the rollout of group activity on an international level, the GHG Protocol was selected as the basis for converting every process into tonnes of CO_2 equivalent.

The Aluminium Division can use the tool immediately to favour certain project scenarios based on a financial investment to carbon footprint optimisation ratio. *"Over time, our aim is to extend it to other pieces of equipment we use, and more broadly to other group divisions, adapting it to their specific activity,"* concludes Guillaume.

/

LESSENING THE IMPACT OF TRANSPORTATION

Installation, commissioning, and maintenance are part of our DNA.
Such operations call for a lot of travel, by people and machines, and represent an obvious opportunity for improvement in our quest to lower greenhouse gases. Dual accounts of new ways forward.

David Director of the Nuclear Production Division

"From a transportation standpoint, the fact that the group has quayside plants – in La Rochelle and La Seyne-sur-Mer in 2023 – is a positive factor for storing and transporting large-scale equipment. The ecological benefit of one leg of maritime transportation versus multistage road delivery is tremendous!
A few years ago, we also launched a policy that favours recruiting personnel located near the facilities we operate. That helps us be closer to our customers, support the communities where we are active, and significantly reduce personnel travel from our head office in France. We calculated that in the last decade, these localisation efforts and the use of public transit have cut the equivalent of 1 million kilometres each year for the NP Division alone. That's about 150 tonnes of CO_2/year! And that's just the beginning. Our decarbonisation goal is quite challenging, and we will be taking many more actions to achieve it."

Sébastien Director, Business Line Service Rhône-Alpes & Lifting Solutions Projects

"Our operations call for a lot of personnel travel. Even though our plants are centrally located in the Rhône-Alpes area, we want to limit our transportation-related impact. We are developing local bases to avoid adding to our carbon footprint. We have also recently implemented an ecodriving indicator to reward the greenest drivers on our teams!"

/ CLIMATE FRESK IN ACTION

Since its launch in 2018, Climate Fresk has brought together over 1.2 million people around the world to learn about climate change issues. Taking the form of games favouring group intelligence, these workshops aim to raise awareness about climate issues. Having experienced the approach themselves, the Director of Human Resources and the Quality, Health, Safety, and Environment Director decided to share the Fresk throughout the group. Accounts from various workshop participants.

Olivier Deputy CEO of REEL International, who organised a workshop for 16 company managers

"The format of the workshop makes it possible to address the topic thoroughly in an enjoyable atmosphere. The scientific data about climate phenomena is made understandable for our teams. The interactive process gives us an opportunity to absorb food for thought and lead to changes in our behaviours. The workshop helps raise our shared awareness as part of a teambuilding activity!"

Eddy South East BL Director, who took part in the Climate Fresk organised by Olivier

"Building the map as a team helped us reflect and share by calling on our collective intelligence. The facts mentioned reflect our daily lives, so it was easy to draw a parallel. We also had the opportunity to experiment with different ways of expressing ourselves that we don't always use, so the more creative among us really let their talents shine. We looked inward to identify what emotions our discussions stirred up, and we discussed what we could do, both in our personal and professional lives.
The workshop has a dual purpose: it raises awareness among employees who may still be oblivious in their private lives, and it helps us realise that through our business operations, we can take action and make changes. Transforming our environmental practices lends additional appeal to our work by stimulating our capacity for innovation. At the South East agency, actions have been taken, such as digitisation to limit our paper usage, and the installation of exterior LED lighting. We want to drive a more ambitious process.
To that end, we want to create work groups to start thinking about things, generating ideas, and bringing them to life, with everyone acting as an agent of change. We could perhaps launch a CSR challenge! Officialising our roadmap across the group will help us make further progress!"

Emmanuelle Health, Safety and Environment Coordinator for North West BL (La Hague agency), who attended the workshop held during the QHSE service seminar

"I took part in the Climate Fresk during the annual Health, Safety, and Environment Day that brings together all group HSE team members. Our director, Nicolas, always holds a team-building activity on these days, and this year, he suggested a Climate Fresk workshop. It was a great surprise: since I'm keenly interested in everything having to do with ecology, I had been following the initiative on social media for some time.
It was highly instructive. I learned a lot of things I had no idea about, and I also realised the scope of our environmental impact. I think we tend to underestimate it when we don't really know.
It made for really beneficial discussions among participants – we were divided into small groups of 6 to 8 people – as we were able to talk one-on-one about topics that resonate with us, both in our professional and personal lives. At the end of the workshop, we stated a few actions we could take rapidly at our own level. Following the workshop, I calculated my personal carbon footprint, and I have made practical decisions to lessen my daily environmental impact: I reuse the household's grey water for the toilets in my home, and I water my garden with water I use to wash food in the kitchen. Since we were renovating our heating system, we opted for a heat pump, which is a more environmentally friendly solution.
From a professional standpoint, part of the second day of the seminar was dedicated to initiatives conducted across the REEL group and our budding CSR process. I was surprised by the number of projects and their scope. It made me proud, and I feel it gives meaning to the work we all do!"

/ OVERVIEW

Responsibility Process

Stakes	Our Actions	Our Aims
Protecting Health & Safety	Health and safety is a recurrent topic that features in its various aspects in several articles in this document. For the essentials, read P. 10 - ***Stake: Health & Safety*** P. 12 - ***MY CARE, Channel for Change*** P. 13 - ***Radiation Protection Policy***	We hold ourselves responsible vis-à-vis all stakeholders – employees, co-contractors, and users of our machines and installations. Developing a safety culture has been part of the group's DNA since day one, with a zero-accident goal.
Being an Employer of Choice	Several measures are in place to reach this goal. For the essentials, read P. 16 - ***Stake: Being an Employer of Choice*** P. 18 - ***REEL Academy, Our Internal School*** P. 20 - ***New Maintenance and Nuclear Training*** P. 20 - ***Passing Our Values on*** P. 21 - ***MY HEROES: Combining Sports and Community Involvement*** P. 22 - ***AWARE: Feminising Our Workforce***	We intend to be a leading employer in the following fields: ***> Employee upskilling and fulfilment*** ***> Quality of life in the workplace*** ***> Onboarding and integration*** ***> Diversity and equity*** ***> Solidarity*** ***> Finding meaning in and at work***
Governance	For the essentials, read P. 26 - ***Stake: Governance*** P. 28 - ***Family Share Ownership and Employee Shareholding*** P. 29 - ***Ethics and Growth***	We intend to be an exemplary company by the quality of our governance, its practice of transparency, and the sharing of its values.
Developing Low-Carbon Energy Projects with Stakeholders	For the essentials, read P. 34 - ***Helping Lower Greenhouse Gas Emissions in the Offshore and Maritime Industries*** P. 36 - ***Nuclear Power in the Age of Energy Transition*** P. 41 - ***Decarbonising the Aluminium Industry***	We help decarbonise the industry by ***> Participating in the new generation of nuclear power plants*** ***> Being involved in innovative projects to lower GHG emissions*** ***> Supporting successful initiatives in the wind power industry***
Reducing our environmental footprint	For the essentials, read P. 44 - ***Stake: Reducing the Environmental Footprint of REEL International*** P. 46 - ***Assessing the Carbon Footprint of Our Equipment*** P. 47 - ***Lessening the Impact of Transportation***	The group has several means of reducing its footprint: ***> The ecodesign of our products and related transportation*** ***> Reducing waste and raw materials used in our equipment*** ***> Implementing an energy savings plan across all sites and processes*** ***> Promoting more environmentally friendly behaviours***

Key Figures & Indicators

These indicators represent data collected at the end of fiscal year 2022 for REEL International.
In all other cases, the scope of the data is shown below the indicator.

Health & Safety

2022

- **18** — *Number of lost-time injuries*
- **78%** — *% of sites with no lost-time injuries*
- **79%** — *% of managers trained on "See It – Say It" safety observation and communication*
- **0** — *Radiation protection: Number of employees with dosimetry > 10 mSv/yr (reminder: French regulation imposes a limit of 20 mSv/yr)*

Employer of Choice

2022

- **46%** — *% of eligible employees who participated in MY SHARE (employee shareholding program)*
- **84** — *Men/Women equality index (France)*
- **82%** — *Acquired skills vs. required skills*

Governance

2022

- **33%** — *% of women members of the board of directors*
- **372** — *Number of managers trained on anti-corruption*
- **1,3** — *Financial independence KPI Gross debt/EBITDA*
- **1** — *Debt/cash ratio – 12-month average*

Low-carbon projects

2022

- **33%** — *of business conducted in low-carbon energy industries*
- **80%** — *of the R&D budget dedicated to projects for lowcarbon forms of energy*

Environmental footprint, 2022 (scope: France)

2022

- **1769** — *Average ratio of electric consumption in kWh per employee (excl. externals)*
- **6.16%** — *% of low-CO_2 emission vehicles ordered vs. total number of vehicles ordered*
- **3.9** for scopes 1 & 2 — *CO_2 emissions (in tonnes of CO_2) vs. sales revenue in M€ for 2019 (last GHG assessment)*

/ Acknowledgements

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